# Isolde Brackwater

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## Profile

Engineering manager for consumer mobile apps: four years in the role and 14 years building software. A team of 7 reports to me, including 5 Android and iOS engineers. I make apps stable and releases routine, then use that safety to run experiments with product. At Quillmarsh, a marketplace for hiring tools and garden equipment, I took crash-free sessions to 99.6% and moved the apps to weekly releases.

## Key Achievements

- Raised crash-free sessions from 97.1% to 99.6% in a year by putting a release health gate on every staged rollout and running weekly crash triage.
- Moved both apps from monthly to weekly releases with staged rollouts: 46 releases in 2023, against 11 the year before.
- Lifted in-app booking conversion from 18% to 23% through a 6-week A/B test of a new checkout, run with the product manager and designer.
- Grew the mobile team from 3 to 7 with 4 hires in 2023, no regretted leavers since 2022, and 2 engineers promoted.

## Professional Experience

### Engineering Manager, Mobile, Quillmarsh

Leeds, UK (remote-first) Apr 2022 - Present

*Scope: native Android and iOS apps and the bookings API behind them. 7 direct reports: 5 mobile engineers, 1 backend engineer, 1 QA engineer. Reports to the VP Engineering.*

- Set the release health gate: no release goes wider than staged rollout below 99.3% crash-free. Crash-free sessions went from 97.1% to 99.6% between Q3 2022 and Q2 2023.
- Moved the apps to a weekly release train with a written checklist and an automated smoke suite. 46 releases in 2023, against 11 in 2022.
- Ran 5 A/B tests with product. The checkout redesign lifted booking conversion from 18% to 23% and shipped to all users in Nov 2023.
- Wrote the interview loop and the take-home exercise, and ran every final interview. Grew the team from 3 to 7; promoted one engineer to senior and one to staff.
- Built a Kotlin Multiplatform proof of concept for shared pricing logic, Jun 2024. Not shipped: the team chose to keep two native apps.
- Sponsored the Android CI work that cut build time from 38 to 14 minutes, Feb 2024.

### Tech Lead, Tidewren

Manchester, UK — Sep 2020 - Mar 2022

*Scope: mobile web checkout and the seat-map service for an online ticketing company. Led a team of 4 as tech lead. Reported to the Head of Engineering.*

- Rebuilt the seat-map ordering flow with the designer. Median mobile checkout time fell from 4 minutes 10 seconds to 2 minutes 5 seconds.
- Led load testing and added a virtual queue before a major on-sale: 9,000 orders in the first hour, no downtime.
- Integrated the payment provider's hosted card fields into checkout.

### Senior Software Engineer, Tidewren

Manchester, UK — Jun 2018 - Aug 2020

- Built the first Android app for ticket wallets in Kotlin.
- Mentored 2 junior engineers.

## Earlier Career

- Software Engineer, Larkspindle, Sep 2014 - May 2018: web and Android apps for retail clients at a digital agency.
- Junior Developer, Marrowby Print, Jul 2012 - Aug 2014: internal order-tracking tools.

## Talks and Open Source

- "Weekly releases without fear", Northern Mobile Meetup, Leeds, May 2024.
- Maintainer of flagburrow, a small Kotlin library for caching feature flags offline.

## Education

- BSc Computer Science, Hallowfield University, 2012.